

PLACEMENT PREPARATION GUIDELINES

01	Online Assessment	Sharpen aptitude & coding skills
02	Communication Skills	GD, self-intro & HR questions
03	Technical Skills	Know your basics inside-out
04	Resume Preparation	One page, crisp, honest & powerful

IMPORTANT: If you are unclear about which domain or role you want to target, please achieve at least **50% clarity before your placement season begins**. Interviewers can sense when a candidate lacks direction — knowing what you want makes you stand out immediately.

PILLAR 1 : ONLINE ASSESSMENT & APTITUDE

The Online Assessment (OA) is usually the very first filter. Companies use it to screen hundreds of applicants in one go. A strong OA score opens the door to everything else. **Prepare consistently — even 30 minutes a day during vacation compounds enormously.**

What the Online Assessment Tests

Quantitative Aptitude	Number systems, percentages, ratios, time & work, time & distance, profit & loss, averages, permutations & combinations, probability.
Logical Reasoning	Series completion, blood relations, coding-decoding, seating arrangements, syllogisms, puzzles, data sufficiency.
Verbal Ability	Reading comprehension, fill-in-the-blanks, sentence correction, para-jumbles, vocabulary, error spotting.
Coding / DSA	Arrays, strings, recursion, sorting, searching, linked lists, stacks, queues, basic dynamic programming (product companies).
Technical MCQs	C/C++/Java/Python basics, OS concepts, DBMS, networking — common in service-based company OAs.

Practice Resources

These are your go-to platforms. Bookmark them today and build a daily habit:

- [CodeHelp Mock Tests](#) — Company-specific mock tests, DSA problems & full OA simulations.
- [IndiaBix](#) — Massive question bank: aptitude, reasoning, verbal, technical MCQs & GD topics.
- [PrepInsta](#) — Company-specific OA patterns, previous year papers, and prime courses.
- [GeeksforGeeks](#) — DSA problems, CS fundamentals articles, company-wise interview experiences.
- [LeetCode](#) — Coding practice; focus Easy to Medium. Essential for product companies.
- [HackerRank](#) — Skills certifications + practice problems. Many companies use its platform directly.
- [Talent Battle](#) — Placement preparation with company-wise aptitude & reasoning practice.

Suggested Vacation Study Plan

Week	Focus Area	Daily Target
Week 1	Quantitative Aptitude basics	20 questions + theory revision
Week 2	Logical Reasoning	20 questions + 1 mock section
Week 3	Verbal Ability + Technical MCQs	15 Verbal + 15 Tech MCQs
Week 4	Coding — Arrays, Strings, Recursion	2 Easy LeetCode problems/day
Week 5	Mixed Mock Tests	1 full OA mock per day, review mistakes
Week 6	Company-specific OA patterns	CodeHelp + PrepInsta company sets

PRO TIP: Analyze every wrong answer. Understanding why you got something wrong is 10x more valuable than solving 10 new questions.

PILLAR 2 : COMMUNICATION SKILLS

Communication is the single biggest differentiator at the same technical skill level. **Many strong candidates are filtered out in the GD or HR round purely because they cannot express themselves clearly.** Use your vacation — start TODAY.

2A. Group Discussion (GD) — The First Big Filter

GDs test your ability to think on your feet, listen actively, communicate clearly, and work as part of a group. The evaluator is watching for:

- **Clarity of thought and structured argument**
- **Active listening — do you acknowledge others' points?**
- **Leadership — guide the discussion constructively without dominating**
- **Body language, eye contact, and confidence**
- **Ability to summarise and conclude**

How to Prepare for GDs:

1. **Pick a topic and write down 5 points FOR and 5 points AGAINST** — on your own, without ChatGPT.
2. Brainstorm out loud or with friends to build the habit of forming thoughts quickly.
3. Read one newspaper or news app (Times of India, BBC) for 20 minutes daily — current affairs awareness is essential.
4. Practice summarizing articles in 3–4 sentences. This trains you to be concise.
5. Join a study group and do mock GDs. Take turns playing devil's advocate.

GD Topic Bank — Practice These

Below is a categorised list. Pick 2–3 topics per week and brainstorm both sides:

Technology & Future of Work

- Work from Home vs. Work from Office
- Making the 4-Day Work Week a Reality in India's IT Sector
- Artificial Intelligence: Job Creator or Job Killer?
- Is Social Media doing more harm than good?
- Should Coding be Mandatory in Schools?
- Data Privacy vs. National Security: Where to draw the line?
- The Future of Electric Vehicles in India

Business & Economics

- Monopoly or Duopoly: Should it be implemented in India?
- Barriers to Entry and the Startups Ecosystem
- Should India adopt a Universal Basic Income?

- Globalization vs. Nationalism — What serves India better?
- Is the Gig Economy good for India's workforce?
- Should Large Corporations be broken up to encourage competition?

Social & Policy Issues

- Brain Drain vs. Brain Gain — Is emigration hurting India?
- Is the Indian Education System preparing students for the real world?
- Reservation System in India: Is it still relevant?
- Mental Health Awareness: Should companies be legally responsible?
- Social Media Influencers — Role Models or Misleaders?

Abstract & Lateral Thinking

- Change is the only constant
- The pen is mightier than the sword
- Failure is the stepping stone to success
- Innovation distinguishes a leader from a follower
- Glass half full or half empty?

2B. Self Introduction — Your Personal Pitch

Your self-introduction sets the tone for the entire interview. It must be confident, crisp, and structured. Target: **55–65 seconds**.

1. Name & Location	Start with your full name and where you are from / where you currently stay.
2. Education	Degree, college, branch, and current year. Include CGPA only if 7.5+.
3. Internship	Company name, role, and one key thing you worked on or achieved.
4. Projects	1–2 projects: problem solved + technology used, one sentence each.
5. Skills	3–4 core technical skills relevant to the role you are applying for.
6. Role & Responsibility	Position in college (club head, event organizer, team lead) — mention briefly.
7. Hobbies	End with 1–2 genuine hobbies. Interviewers often ask a follow-up here.

Example Opening: "Good morning! I am [Name], from [City]. I am pursuing B.Tech in Computer Science at [College], final year, CGPA [X]. Last summer, I interned at [Company] where I worked on [brief task]. I have built projects using [Tech Stack]..."

2C. Must-Prepare HR / Behavioural Questions

Prepare genuine, thoughtful answers — not ChatGPT answers:

Classic Questions

- Tell me about yourself.
- What are your strengths? Give an example for each.
- What are your weaknesses? What are you doing to improve them?
- Where do you see yourself in 5 years?
- Why do you want to join our company specifically?
- What do you know about our company / product / services?
- Why should we hire you over other candidates?

Situational / Behavioural

- Tell me about a time you faced a challenge and how you overcame it.
- Describe a situation where you worked as part of a team.
- Tell me about a project you are most proud of — and why.
- Have you ever failed at something? What did you learn?
- How do you handle pressure or a tight deadline?
- Describe a time you disagreed with a team member. How did you handle it?

Role & Career Clarity

- What role are you applying for and why does it interest you?
- Are you comfortable with relocation / travel?
- Do you prefer working alone or in a team? Why?
- What motivates you to perform your best?
- How do you keep yourself updated on technology trends?
- What are your salary expectations? (Research market rate before answering)

Closing Questions to Ask the Interviewer

- What does the onboarding process look like?
- What does a typical day/week look like in this role?
- What skills do you value most in someone joining this team?
- What is the learning curve for a fresher in this role?

Tip: Ask questions related on the things that interested you while reading about the company shows your curiosity and you have come prepared

PILLAR 3 : TECHNICAL SKILLS — KNOW YOUR BASICS INSIDE OUT

You do not need to know everything. You need to know what you put on your resume and the fundamentals of your branch — perfectly. Interviewers will probe any skill you claim. Know it or do not write it.

Core CS Fundamentals

- Data Structures: Arrays, Linked List, Stack, Queue, Trees (BST, Binary Tree), Graphs, Hashing
- Algorithms: Sorting (Bubble, Selection, Merge, Quick), Binary Search, Time & Space Complexity (Big-O)
- Object-Oriented Programming: 4 pillars — Encapsulation, Inheritance, Polymorphism, Abstraction; SOLID principles
- Operating Systems: Process vs Thread, Deadlock, Semaphore, Paging, Virtual Memory
- DBMS: ER Diagrams, Normalisation (1NF–3NF), SQL Queries (Joins, Subqueries, Indexes, Transactions, ACID)
- Computer Networks: OSI model, TCP/IP, HTTP/HTTPS, DNS, subnetting basics

Programming Language Fundamentals

- Pick your primary language (C++/Java/Python) and know it thoroughly: syntax, OOP, standard library
- Write clean, readable code — naming conventions, comments, modular functions
- Practice writing code on paper/whiteboard — many interviews are pen-and-paper
- Know time & space complexity of every data structure operation you discuss

Web / Application Development (if applicable)

- Frontend: HTML, CSS, JavaScript — know the basics even if you are not a frontend dev
- Backend: REST APIs, HTTP methods (GET/POST/PUT/DELETE), JSON, authentication basics
- Database connectivity: How your backend communicates with a database
- Version control: Git — add, commit, push, pull, branch, merge (non-negotiable in industry)

Project Knowledge (Very Important)

- Be ready to explain every decision in your project — what it does, why you chose that approach
- Know the tech stack: why did you choose this language / framework / database?
- Prepare for: 'What would you improve in your project if you had more time?'
- Be honest about your contribution — especially in team projects

Good-to-Have Skills for Fresher's

- Exposure to Cloud basics: AWS/GCP/Azure (even a free-tier project counts)
- Basic Docker / containerization concepts
- Agile / Scrum methodology awareness (most IT companies follow this)
- Problem-solving on LeetCode: aim for 50+ Easy problems before placements

BE HONEST ABOUT YOUR SKILLS. If you list something on your resume, be ready to answer 10 questions about it. If you are not confident, remove it. Bluffing in a technical round is the fastest way to be rejected.

Know the Company Before You Walk In

- Visit the company's official website — read the About Us and Products/Services sections carefully.
- Understand their business model: what do they make/sell/provide, who are their clients?
- Know their recent news: new product launches, acquisitions, funding rounds.
- Understand the role you are applying for: read the job description word by word.
- Find out what tech stack the company primarily uses — try to relate it to your skills.
- Check Glassdoor / AmbitionBox for interview experiences from previous candidates.

Senior Guidance Drive (Company-Specific Resources): [Click Here to Access](#)

PILLAR 4: RESUME — ONE PAGE, CRISP & HONEST

Your resume is your marketing document. It gets you in the room. A recruiter spends an average of **6–8 seconds** on a first scan. Make every word count. One page. No fluff. No lies.

Resume Sections (in order)

- Contact Information — Name, Phone, Email (professional), LinkedIn URL, GitHub URL
- Education — College, Degree, Branch, CGPA, Year of Passing
- Internship / Work Experience — Company, Role, Duration, 2–3 bullet point achievements
- Projects — Project Name, Tech Stack, 2–3 bullet points describing what it does and your role
- Skills — Technical skills only; categorise: Languages, Frameworks, Tools, Databases
- Certifications — Include only relevant certifications (Coursera, NPTEL, etc.)
- Positions of Responsibility — Club head, event coordinator, team lead, etc.
- Achievements / Awards — Hackathons, coding competitions, academic awards
- Hobbies — Optional; only if they add something to your profile

Resume Golden Rules

- Strictly ONE page — use a clean ATS-friendly template (Google Docs / Overleaf)
- Font: Times New Roman or Arial, size 10–12pt
- No big words / jargon that you cannot explain — keep the language simple and direct
- Use action verbs: Built, Designed, Developed, Led, Optimised, Reduced, Increased
- Quantify where possible: 'Reduced API response time by 30%' is better than 'Improved performance'
- No photos, no fancy borders, no heavy colours — professional and ATS-safe
- Proofread thoroughly — zero spelling or grammar errors are expected
- Save as PDF: Filename should be 'YourName_Resume.pdf'

Common Resume Mistakes to Avoid

- Listing skills you barely know
- Using the same resume for every application without any customisation
- Objective statements that say nothing: 'Seeking a challenging position to grow...' — delete this
- Including your Class 10 / 12 scores unless they are exceptional (90%+)
- Putting 'References available on request' — just remove this line entirely
- Inconsistent formatting, multiple font sizes, misaligned bullet points

Free Resume Builder Resources

- [Overleaf \(LaTeX Resume Templates\)](#)
- [FlowCV](#)
- [Resume.io](#)
- [Canva \(use simple templates only\)](#)
- [Google Docs Resume Templates](#)

FINAL WORDS : MINDSET, CONFIDENCE & STRATEGY

Technical skills and preparation are necessary — but they are not sufficient. What wins interviews is the combination of preparation + presence + authenticity. Here is what separates candidates who get offers from those who do not:

Be Honest, Be Yourself	Interviewers have heard every scripted answer. Authenticity is disarming and memorable. If you do not know something, say 'I am not sure, but here is how I would approach it.'
Sell Yourself — Get Into Their Shoes	Before every interview, ask: 'What is this company looking for?' Then speak to exactly that. Read the job description line by line. Mirror their language back in your answers.
Study the Company — No Excuses	Go to their website. Read the About section, Products, Clients, and Recent News. Mentioning a specific company project or value instantly differentiates you from 90% of candidates.
Work on Speaking if it is a Weakness	This is the time. Do mirror practice, record yourself on your phone. The ability to express your thoughts clearly is a skill — it improves with deliberate practice. Start now.
Be Confident — Stay Calm	Nervousness is normal. Take a breath before answering. It is perfectly fine to say: 'Give me a moment to think.' Composed candidates come across as mature and professional.
Clarity of Direction	Before placements begin, know — even roughly — whether you want service-based IT, product companies, core branch roles, startups, or higher studies. At least 50% clarity is essential.

Pre-Placement Vacation Checklist

- ☐ I have started practising aptitude questions daily (IndiaBix / CodeHelp)
- ☐ I have solved at least 30 LeetCode Easy problems
- ☐ I have prepared and timed my 60-second self introduction
- ☐ I have prepared answers for the top 15 HR questions
- ☐ I have done at least 5 mock GDs with friends or peers
- ☐ I have identified 5–8 companies I want to target and researched them
- ☐ I have a clean, one-page resume that has been proofread by someone else
- ☐ I have reviewed my projects and can answer 10 questions on each
- ☐ I have at least 50% clarity on what role / domain I am targeting
- ☐ I have accessed the Senior Guidance Drive for company-specific tips

Quick Reference Links

- [CodeHelp Mock Tests](https://www.codehelp.in/dashboard/mock-tests) — <https://www.codehelp.in/dashboard/mock-tests>
- [IndiaBix — Aptitude & GD](https://www.indiabix.com/) — <https://www.indiabix.com/>
- [PrepInsta](https://prepinsta.com/) — <https://prepinsta.com/>
- [GeeksforGeeks](https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/) — <https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/>
- [LeetCode](https://leetcode.com/) — <https://leetcode.com/>
- [HackerRank](https://www.hackerrank.com/) — <https://www.hackerrank.com/>
- [Senior Guidance Drive](https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1HCTz_TZnLGtyt_htF2RBt8Z_6SBZMKb4?usp=sharing) — https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1HCTz_TZnLGtyt_htF2RBt8Z_6SBZMKb4?usp=sharing
- [Overleaf Resume Templates](https://www.overleaf.com/latex/templates/tagged/cv) — <https://www.overleaf.com/latex/templates/tagged/cv>
- [FlowCV Resume Builder](https://flowcv.com/) — <https://flowcv.com/>
- [AmbitionBox — Company Reviews](https://www.ambitionbox.com/) — <https://www.ambitionbox.com/>

Be confident. Stay calm. You have worked for this.